

UTT Chapter 13 Assignment

Hello!

Sorry I haven't written lately. Classes picked up pretty quickly with the first round of exams. Thankfully, midterms are still a few weeks off. That still doesn't stop us from dreaming about spring break though! Nathan, Sarah, and Paige invited me to go skiing with them in Colorado, but Mark and Muhammad are going hiking in the Appalachians. I haven't been skiing or hiking in several years, so both options sound like awesome adventures. What are your plans for the break?

Over the last few weeks, I have been trying out the fencing team here at the university. After watching a lot of pirate movies with my little brother over Christmas break, I decided to learn how to sword fight. Let me tell you, it is a lot more difficult than you would think. Thankfully, Mark has been going with me, and he is just as bad as I am! It is a great stress reliever after all that studying. If you come up to visit, maybe I can take you to a practice and show you the ropes!

While walking to practice the other day, Mark and I ran into Sarah. She and some other students were passing out flyers in the quad. They were advertising a student government debate about the role of family in society and the state. Obviously, Mark was really interested, so we began to discuss the topic. Sarah said we should encourage alternative lifestyles and family structures. According to her, society should be free from arbitrary constraints that religion places on progress. I assume that her views on the family are grounded in her Secularist views, but I don't know exactly how. **What does Secularism have to say about sociology?** Mark agreed that the traditional idea of the family hinders the progress of society, but he said it was because the family causes the "illicit hoarding of capital and wealth." To be honest, I have no idea what he meant. Mark mentioned Karl Marx's sociological views frequently, so I am assuming that Marxism has a lot to say about the relationship between people and society. **What is the Marxist view of sociology?**

In the middle of the conversation, Muhammad rode up on his bike and joined the discussion. At first I thought our views would be similar since we both believe in a God, but I was just as confused when he began talking about removing the separation of church and state. Unfortunately, Mark and I had to run to fencing practice, so I didn't hear the rest of what Muhammad was saying. Maybe you can help. **What is the role of sociology in Islam?** And **what is the Christian view of sociology?**

Well, the break between classes is almost over. I can't wait to hear back from you!

See you later!

-Doug